

REKINDLE THE ROMANCE

MISSING THE INITIAL SPARK YOU FELT WITH YOUR GADGET? HERE ARE SOME WAYS TO REKINDLE IT



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We've all felt that starry-eyed, instant connection with a new gadget at some point. Peeling off the packaging, opening the contents of the box, and finally, laying your eyes on your new gadget for the first time can be a magical experience. Days, and sometimes months, go by and you continue handling your device with care and love, however, there comes a certain time when the spark just fades. This is a culmination of you, the user, getting used to the device and the device itself losing its initial charm. The device starts to become slower, bent out of shape (especially if you're clumsy) and just generally loses its "new" feel.

Gadgets are becoming increasingly exorbitant these days. For example, premium, flagship smartphones these days routinely cross the one lakh rupee price point but there was a time one couldn't imagine spending that kind of money on a phone. It's imperative, now more than ever, to extend the lifespan of your devices and use them for as long as possible since it is not just good for the environment but also for your wallet. However, the irresistible call of spanking new gadgets can serve as a deterrent in this regard. It only makes

sense to try and rekindle the romance you once felt with your trusty, albeit aged, device. In this article, we will take you through a few ways you can possibly reignite the spark you felt initially with your device, and hopefully, that should be enough for you to hold on to it for a few more years.

CARING FOR YOUR GADGETS

Users who care for their gadgets on a regular basis usually end up using them for a couple of years now than those who have a more lax attitude. If you put some effort into caring for your devices, they usually retain their "new-ness" for longer periods of time. Let's look at some gadget care tips that can make your gadgets last a bit longer.

1. Laptops - You can use basic household items to clean your laptop regularly. Use a microfiber cloth to routinely wipe down your screen from time to time. You can also detach your laptop's battery and wipe it



Caring for your gadgets goes a long way

down with the same cloth. A good investment is a dust blower that you can use to blow out tiny particles of dust or debris in between keys, USB ports, and other nooks and crannies. To clean the outside of your laptop, simply dab a cotton ball in some isopropyl alcohol and wipe it down to have it sparkling and shining. Avoid any wet wipes, detergent or harsh chemicals though.

2. Smartphones - As we use our smartphones for long hours every day, they tend to see the most damage be it a scratched screen, scuff marks from drops, or dust inside ports. It's a good idea to clean them from time to time. To do it, remove the phone from its case and gently rub off smudges and marks on the body using a microfiber cloth. To clean the charging port and audio jack, dip the corner of a soft cloth (with no lint) in some isopropyl alcohol and clean them out. Allow the phone to air dry after that.

3. Television - A television needs to be cleaned from time-to-time as well to have a good viewing experience. Use a soft and dry microfiber towel to wipe down the screen a few times a month. You can also use a dust blower or a can of compressed air to remove dirt and dust particles from vents and ports. Don't forget to clean that remote control as well using the same tools.

4. Headphones and earphones - Earphones' ear tips and headphones' ear cups often get soiled due to dust, dirt, sweat, and well ... earwax. So cleaning them from time-to-time is necessary. Use isopropyl alcohol to clean these parts and then air dry them completely before using them. You can also get rid of dust from headphones using compressed air canisters.

5. PC components - In order to deep clean your PC components, you will need to have equipment such as a screwdriver, a can of compressed air, a dust blower, Q-tips, isopropyl alcohol and a cleaning cloth. You can use isopropyl alcohol or just